

Is Malta seventh in the EU for cars per person?

A media report of Eurostat figures, tested against the data

THE CLAIM

“Malta is ranked number seven, just between Germany and Poland ... with 585 cars per 1,000 inhabitants.”

Lovin Malta, 21 September 2024

The outlet's own text, citing Eurostat. No year is given for the figure.

Eurostat counts passenger cars at year end per resident; the figures match 2022.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Right for 2022;
the year is not stated.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

585

The figure is right

Eurostat, 2022: passenger cars per 1,000 inhabitants in Malta. No flag on the value.

7th of 27

So is the rank

Between Germany (587) and Poland (584). All 27 Member States report for 2022.

2022

But which year?

The article calls the data “as of 2023”. Its figures are 2022's; on 2023 figures Malta is 11th.

14th

Lower since

571 in 2025, below the EU-27's 584. The population grew faster than the number of cars.

1,014

Cars per km² of land

Most in the EU by far in 2022 (Netherlands 261). Malta has 313 km² of land, not 246.

FAIR TO SAY

The number of cars in Malta rose every year to 335,693 at the end of 2025; cars per person fell because the population grew faster (+39.6% against +34.5% since the end of 2012).

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The graphic Lovin Malta used, and its data date.

☐ When Eurostat first published the 2023 values.

☐ NSO: licensed versus garaged and rented cars.